

1 **SENATE FLOOR VERSION**

2 February 25, 2025

3 COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE
4 FOR

5 SENATE BILL NO. 481

By: Deevers

6
7 An Act relating to public employees; prohibiting
8 certain public employees from participating in
9 certain forms of protest under certain circumstances;
10 providing exceptions; prohibiting use of certain
11 publicly owned or funded equipment or assets for
12 certain purposes; providing for codification;
13 providing an effective date; and declaring an
14 emergency.

15 BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

16 SECTION 1. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
17 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 840-2.31 of Title 74, unless
18 there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

19 A. No public employee, including an employee of a state agency,
20 a political subdivision, or a school district, whose salary or wages
21 are paid with taxpayer dollars may speak on or participate in a
22 matter of public concern deemed a matter of larger societal
23 significance or importance, either as an individual or as an
24 organized form of protest, during the employee's normal work hours;
provided, a public employee is authorized to engage in such conduct
during normal work hours if the employee uses annual leave and the

1 actions of the employee will not create an undue burden on the
2 employer's interests in an efficient, disruptive-free workplace.

3 B. In no event shall a public employee use assets or equipment
4 owned by the state, a political subdivision, or a school district
5 for any purpose, other than at school events or for express purposes
6 outlined in the employee's job description, for conduct pursuant to
7 subsection A of this section, including, but not limited to:

8 1. Computer equipment, including equipment that facilitates the
9 use of email, text messaging, or social media from any state-owned,
10 -leased, or -funded devices;

11 2. Transportation equipment, including any vehicles, school
12 buses, trailers, or other modes of transportation; or

13 3. Any other materials, including food, sound equipment, or
14 material utilizing the employer emblem, insignia, or symbol.

15 SECTION 2. This act shall become effective July 1, 2025.

16 SECTION 3. It being immediately necessary for the preservation
17 of the public peace, health or safety, an emergency is hereby
18 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and
19 be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

20 COMMITTEE REPORT BY: COMMITTEE ON RETIREMENT AND GOVERNMENT
RESOURCES

21 February 25, 2025 - DO PASS AS AMENDED BY CS